

2. REQUIREMENTS ANALYSIS PHASE

2.1 Overview

This phase sets out the functional and non-functional requirements needed to build the Incident Lifecycle Management solution in ServiceNow. These requirements are drawn directly from the day-to-day tasks a Service Desk agent and the wider technical support organization carry out while working an incident.

2.2 Stakeholders Involved

End User / Caller

Reports the issue or service disruption and supplies the details needed to investigate it.

Service Desk Agent

Logs the incident, confirms the details provided, classifies it, carries out first-line investigation, keeps the caller informed, and closes out straightforward incidents.

Level 2 Support Team

Takes on incidents that call for deeper technical investigation and specialist skills.

Assignment Group

The technical team responsible for investigating and resolving incidents routed to their area.

Change Management Team

Manages any change — including emergency changes — needed to resolve an incident.

Knowledge Management Team

Owns and maintains the library of reusable solutions and knowledge articles.

ServiceNow Administrator

Configures users, groups, services, workflow logic, permissions, SLA definitions, and other platform components.

2.3 Functional Requirements

FR1 — Service / Service Offering Setup

The platform must allow a service or service offering to be defined and made available for use in incident records.

FR2 — Logging an Incident

A Service Desk Agent must be able to log a new incident capturing:

- Caller
- Short description
- Full description
- Service
- Service offering
- Category
- Subcategory
- Configuration Item
- Impact
- Urgency
- Priority
- Assignment group
- Assigned to
- State

FR3 — Classifying an Incident

The platform must support classifying incidents by:

- Category
- Subcategory
- Impact
- Urgency
- Priority

Accurate classification ensures high-severity incidents get the attention they need first.

FR4 — Assigning an Incident

Incidents must be routed to the appropriate support group based on the nature of the issue, and that team must be able to investigate and update the record.

FR5 — Escalating an Incident

If first-line support cannot resolve an incident, it must be escalated to the relevant Level 2 team, with all prior investigation notes carried forward.

FR6 — Connecting to Knowledge

Agents must be able to search existing knowledge articles while investigating a ticket, and apply an existing solution when one is found.

FR7 — Raising an Emergency Change

When resolving an incident requires an urgent change to the IT environment, the platform must allow an emergency change request to be raised and linked back to the incident, preserving traceability between the reported problem and the fix applied.

FR8 — Creating a Child Incident

The platform must support creating child incidents where several tickets stem from one common parent issue, and must preserve that parent-child link.

FR9 — Resolving an Incident

Once a fix is applied, the agent must update the incident with:

- Resolution code
- Resolution notes
- Fix details
- Relevant comments

FR10 — Authoring a Knowledge Article

Where a solution could help with future incidents, the platform must support creating a knowledge article describing the problem, its cause, and how it was resolved.

FR11 — Tracking SLA

The platform must track the SLA that applies to each incident, letting teams see whether it is:

- Within target
- Approaching breach
- Breached

FR12 — Verifying Related Records

The platform must display the links between an incident and its related records, including:

- Child incidents
- Change requests
- Knowledge articles
- SLA records

2.4 Non-Functional Requirements

Usability

The interface for logging, updating, and tracking incidents should be straightforward to use.

Performance

Incident data and related records should load without noticeable delay.

Security

Access to incident, change, and knowledge data should be restricted according to each user's role.

Reliability

Incident data must be stored durably, with no risk of loss.

Scalability

The platform must handle growth in both incident volume and user count.

Maintainability

Administrators should be able to adjust configuration and workflows as business needs evolve.

Auditability

Every meaningful change to an incident record should be traceable via its activity history.

2.5 Outcome of the Analysis

Based on this analysis, the solution requires the following ServiceNow modules: **Incident Management, Service Management, Assignment Management, Knowledge Management, Change Management, SLA Management, and Related Record Management.**